public debates – albeit debates in which the winner took all, with the loser required to accept either Shankara as guru, banishment, or even, as a third option, suicide by self-immolation.

All the same, there are texts which record the persecution and expulsion of all Buddhists from Kerala by an eighth-century Malayali king named Sudhavana, supposedly at the instigation of an anti-Buddhist Brahman named Kumarila Bhat. The earliest biography of Shankara, *Sankara Digvijaya*, tells the same story, and has King Sudhavana ordering his servants to 'kill all Buddhists from Himalaya to Rameshwaram, even children and the elderly. Whosoever will not kill them, will be killed at my hands.' There are also twelfth-century inscriptions on the walls of a number of Shaiva temples in the districts of Bijapur and Dharwad in Karnataka lauding the anti-Jain activities of three feudatory chiefs of the Western Chalukyas named Ekantada Ramayya, Viruprasa and Vira-Goggideva, the last described as 'a fire to the Jain scriptures' and 'a hunter of the wild beasts in the form of the followers of the Jina'. The temple of Somesvara in Ablur village, for example, contains several sculptured panels with graphic descriptions attached. One shows Ekantada Ramayya smashing a Jain statue and replacing it with a linga, the accompanying inscription reading (in P. B. Desai's reading): 'At this place Ekantada Ramayya breaking the Jaina and setting up the Sivalinga.' A second inscription above another panel is longer: 'This is the place representing how at the temple of the illustrious Brahmeshvara, Ekantada Ramayya laid a wager, at the cost of the Jina of the shrine, of cutting off his head and receiving it back on again. When Sanka-gavunda would not let him destroy the shrine of the Jina, arraying his men and horses against him, Ekantada Ramayya fought and vanquished him and installed the linga.'[9]